



A recipe for super rice

Seeds for new plants are formed when pollen meets an egg. Longping knew that farmed rice plants usually pollinated themselves, making it difficult to breed them with other rice plants. However, in 1970, he came across some wild rice that had eggs and no pollen. It was perfect for what he needed.

By 1973, Longping had bred the wild rice with the farmed rice to create a new species of super rice, which produced 20 percent more grain than normal! He continued his work for three decades, getting better and better results. The super rice helped to ensure a steady supply of food in China, because more rice could be grown on less land. Now grown on other continents, too, the rice is helping to tackle food shortages around the world.



Hybrid rice

When two things are combined to make something new, it's called a hybrid. Plants created from parents of two different plant varieties often grow faster and produce more seeds.



Longping is still trying to improve the super rice, helping it to capture more of the sun's energy to grow even better.

in China, but it belongs to all.

